Time Travel in the Mandar TP:

Ellipsis, Linearization, and the Phonological ECP

Dan Brodkin — BMW (Exo-Words IV) — May 1, 2026 — dbrodkin@sas.upenn.edu

The broad goal of this talk: to push forward our understanding of the **PF branch**
(the series of feed-forward modules that convert syntactic representations to phonetic strings)
by studying how familiar systems interact with **prosodic structure** & **output constraints**.

Architectural foundations:

1. The morphological module — Halle & Marantz 1993; Arregi & Nevins 2012
   - Reworks the output of the syntax into a fully morphological representation
   - Home to morphological operations like fission, fusion, insertion, obliteration
   - Builds constituent structure to define domains for these operations (M-words)
2. The phonology — Prince & Smolensky 2004; Selkirk 2009
   - Reworks the output of the morphology into a phonological representation
   - Home to phonological processes; output constraints; prosodic constituents
   - Reinstantiates morphosyntactic constituent structure in phonological terms
3. The target today: how do these modules work, individually or together, to determine how the terminal nodes of the syntax are exponed and linearized?

The narrow domain: the postsyntactic consequences of stranding.

The exponents of functional heads are often phonologically small, in many ways, but:

(1) a. My friends [$_\omega$ sh'/c'] [$_\omega$ go]] b. [$_\omega$ [$_\omega$ My friends] 'll/'d] go.

(2) *The Phonological ECP*:

a. I'd never go, but [$_\omega$ you] [$_\omega$ should / could / would / will / have / are]

b. [$_\omega$ [$_\omega$ you] sh' c' 'd 'll 've 're]

Classical analysis: suppletion,
driven by a surface-oriented phonological requirement to build words before ellipsis sites.
(King 1970; Bresnan 1971; Zwicky 1977; Kaisse 1985; Selkirk 1995; Pullum & Zwicky 1998; Anderson 2008; Itô & Mester 2019; and for discussion, Potsdam 1996, 1997; Conner 2019)

The bridge to linearization: a specific effect in Mandar, a language of Indonesia. From a text on courtship:

(3) *Time Travel* Mamuju: Rasyid & Usmar 1998, 6:46-50

a. **De**=areki **na** diang tarento' ampunna' ingkai' domai molabu.
not=prt will there be waves if we come here to harbor
'We hope there won't be any waves if we come here to harbor.'

b. Ampunna' diang ki akkattata' na domai molabu,
If there is your intention to come here to harbor
'If you have the intention of coming here to harbor,

tente mo inne: so'nai mo kipatipatindoang barang tallumbongi,
like this leave it for us to sleep on roughly three nights
'this is what we'll do: let us sleep on it for a few nights,

ampele' mengkatanda a' ingkai' mating di ingkita'
and then signal we to you
'and then we will signal to you

na mabombang ai **na** **u'de** [$_{VP}$ __ ~~mabombang~~] ai.
will turbulent prt will not turbulent prt
'Whether it will be turbulent or whether it will not.'

Roadmap:

1. Background Syntax: negation & the future proclitic = heads in the extended tp; hierarchically pol^0 > tense^0; license ellipsis of the *voice*p and invert in that context.
2. The Phonology of Ellipsis: phonological phrases are built around functional xps, like the tp, and stranded functional heads are made into words to "fill them out."
3. The Structure of Time Travel: the future proclitic is shifted left in the phonology to "escape the responsibilities" of being the last element in the phonological phrase.

Vision:

1. In the phonology: prosodic structure must be built in a global and parallel calculus that allows for item-specific repairs to output constraints (Pater 2000; Selkirk 2009)
2. Along the pf branch: linear order and exponence ≈ surface prosodic constituency: established by the phonology and morphology in a gradual process of translation.

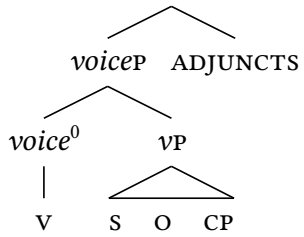
1 Background

The focus of this talk will fall on Mandar, an Austronesian language of Central Indonesia.

- South Sulawesi subfamily (Esser 1938); related to Makassarese, Selayarese, Konjo
- Half a million speakers in the province of West Sulawesi; shift toward Indonesian
- Descriptive work: Pelenkahu *et al.* 1983; Sikki *et al.* 1987; Muthalib & Sangi 1991
- Today's data: drawn from elicitation with a single speaker, Jupri Talib (2018—); conducted in Mandar and Indonesian; supplemented with regular trips to the field.

Mandar is a verb-initial language that shows a basic order of VSO. The verb undergoes head-movement to *voice*^{0} and postverbal arguments are spelled out in their base positions. Locative and temporal adjuncts follow the VSO string, yielding this kind of clausal syntax:

(4) *Clausal Syntax*



Above the verb, the language has a class of rigidly ordered AUXES that spell out POLARITY^0, TENSE^0, and a series of aspectual heads. These heads block higher verb-raising, form words with the verb, and pattern together in many other ways (contrasting with raising verbs).

(5) *The Auxiliaries*

POL^0		> TENSE^0		> ASP$^0_{HAB}$ >	ASP$^0_{EXP}$ >	ASP$^0_{COMP}$	
ndang,	*da*	*pura*,	*na*	*byasa*	*rua*	*yari*,	*taN-*
not	don't	PAST	FUT	usually	ever	DID	DID NOT

Above the auxiliaries, there are two more heads that host viewpoint aspect clitics and absolutive agreement. These take the order ASP$_{VIEW}$ > T$^0_{AGR}$ and surface in second-position:

(6) *Higher Functional Heads*

a. POL^0=[ASP$_{VIEW}{}^0$+T^0] … ASP$^0_{HAB}$ … *voice*^{0}

b. ___ ASP$^0_{HAB}$=[ASP$_{VIEW}{}^0$+T^0] … *voice*^{0}

c. ___ ___ *voice*^{0}=[ASP$_{VIEW}{}^0$+T^0]

2 VP-Ellipsis

The auxiliaries generally license a type of ellipsis that suppresses the verb and preserves everything above the *voice*P, like all higher AUXES, ABS agreement, and viewpoint aspect.

(7) *VPE in Mandar*

a. Arere, yari mi mu-tumae?
oh god DID now.3ABS 2ERG-propose
'Oh god, you did propose to her?'

b. Iyo', yari mi Δ todi'.
yes DID now.3ABS unfortunately
'Yeah, unfortunately I did.'

This process shows the usual syntactic properties of VPE, it's clearly distinct from stripping and polarity ellipsis, and it's translated naturally into VPE in Indonesian (Fortin 2007).

(8) *Properties of VPE*

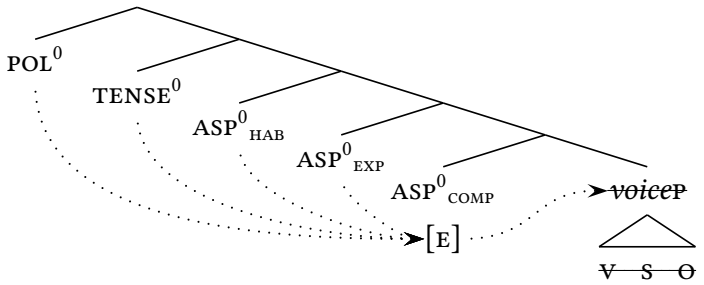
a. Rua i ma'bottor iKaco', tapi **ndang** a' Δ.
has 3ABS gamble NAME but not 1ABS
'Kacho' has gambled, but I don't.

b. Pura tappa'da' ma'dosa mua' **pura** to-o Δ.
PAST only.1ABS sin if PAST also-2ABS
'I only sinned if you did too.'

c. Na-soso' i iKaco' alawena na **rua** to-a' Δ .
3ERG-pity 3ABS NAME himself and have also-1ABS
'Kacho' has gotten down on himself and I have, too.'

PROPOSAL: this is ellipsis of the *voice*P. The contents of the *voice*P fail to undergo VI at PF, because they're marked by a feature [†] that percolates downward from the *voice*P node, assigned to the *voice*P by its sister in the syntax and plausibly activated by higher heads.

(9) *Suppressing the VoiceP*



(And for much discussion: Merchant 2001; Saab 2008, 2010; Aelbrecht 2010; Stigliano 2022)

Within these configurations, the absolutive argument is realized in one of three ways. When it's given, it's pro-dropped and cannot be realized in its base position.

(10) *Given Absolutives*

a. Ma'ua i iKaco' mua' lamba i,
say 3ABS NAME that go 3ABS
'Kacho' said that he went,'

b. Tapi minnassa i mua' ndang i [$_{voiceP}$ ~~lamba~~ (*__do__ __asu__)].
but clear 3ABS that not 3ABS go that dog
'But it's clear that [*pro* / *that jackass] didn't.'

When it's lightly focused, it's realized in a position that precedes the auxiliaries (11a). When it's heavily focused, it takes a similar position but ABS agreement disappears (11b). This is a consequence of a higher step of focus-movement: an ANTI-AGREEMENT EFFECT.

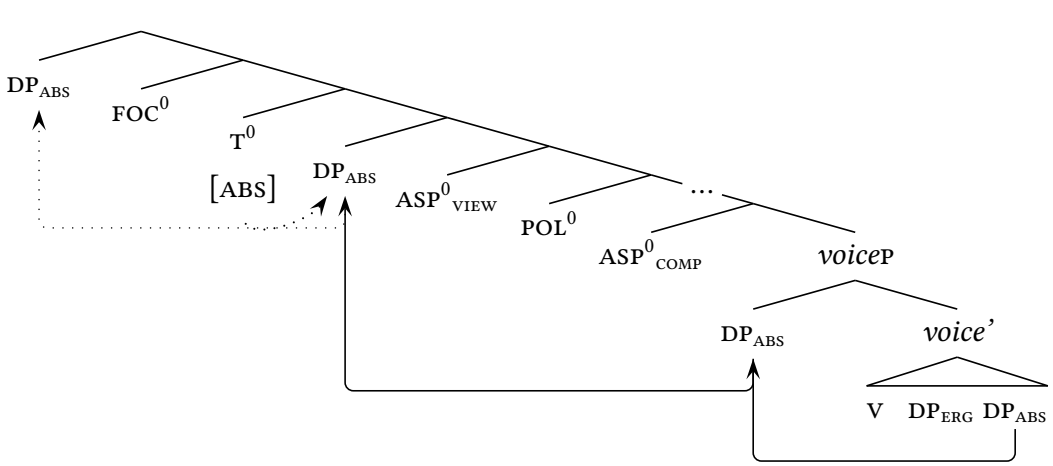
(11) *Focused Absolutives*

a. Ndang i lamba iCicci', tapi [$_{TP}$ iKaco' yari i Δ].
not 3ABS go NAME but NAME DID 3ABS
'Chichi' didn't go, but KACO' DID.'

b. Parallu diang lamba na [$_{FOCP}$ **IKACO'** yari ___ Δ].
need someone go and NAME DID (*3ABS)
'Someone had to go and KACHO' did.'

Integrating these facts with the wider clausal syntax:

(12)



(and see also: Guilfoyle *et al.* 1992; Aldridge 2004; Erlewine 2018; Nie 2020; Brodkin 2022)

3 Time Travel

Mandar has a future proclitic *na* that takes the same linear position as the past-tense auxiliary *pura*: it follows the negator and precedes the aspectual *byasa*, *rua*, and *yari*.

(13) *The Future Proclitic*

a. Ndang a' **na** rua yari u-inda'i boyammu!
not 1ABS will ever DO 1ERG-set foot in your house
'I'll never set foot in your house!'

b. Pole-mu ri Alaska, **na** rua i mu-sa'ding maringing.
come-2GEN from Alaska, will ever 3ABS 2ERG-feel cold
'When you come back from Alaska, you will have experienced the cold.'

The future proclitic can't host second-position clitics (14a) or license VPE alone (14b).

(14) *Two Restrictions*

a. **Na** siala i iKaco' sola iCicci', de.
will marry 3ABS NAME with NAME PRT
'Kacho' will get married with Chichi', huh.'

b. iKaco' ndang lamba, tapi iCicci' **pura** / ***na** Δ a?
NAME not go but NAME PAST/*will PRT
'KACHO' didn't go, but CHICHI' [did / *'ll], eh?

But it can fall before VPE sites when it follows the negator *ndang*:

(15) *Utterance-Final Stranding*

a. iCicci' lulus, tapi yau ndan **na'** Δ
NAME graduate but 1SG not FUT
'CHICHI' graduated, but I won't.'

b. Angga'-na todi' yau to'o ndan **na'** Δ
seems-3GEN sadly 1SG also not FUT
'Sadly, seems like I ALSO won't.'

Compare:

(16) a. *I've'nt gone b. ...*but I've Δ c. ...but I coulda Δ

There's something special in this system about the final position in the utterance.
When the negator is stranded there, it retains its usual form, but when it's not:

(17) *Positional Alternations*

a. iCicci' lulus, tapi yau **ndang** Δ
NAME graduate but 1SG not
'Chichi' graduated, but I won't.'

b. Angga'-na yau to'o **andiang** Δ de'
seems-3GEN 1SG also not I guess
'Seems like I also won't, I guess.'

The future proclitic shows a similar effect:
Whenever it can't be stranded at the right edge of the utterance, it shifts to the left.

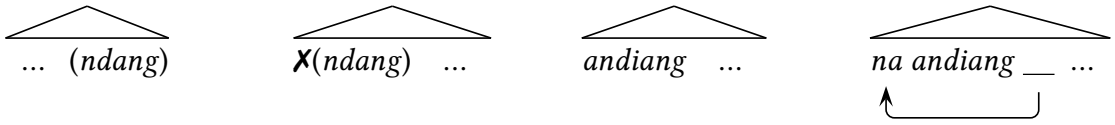
(18) *Time Travel*

a. Lamba tappa'da' apa' i'o **na** andiang __ **o** Δ!
go only.1ABS because 2SG will not 2ABS
'I'm only going because you won't!'

b. Ndang o na lao mua' iCicci' **na** andiang __ Δ **a**?
not 2ABS will go if NAME will not PRT
'You won't go if Chichi won't, eh?

Phonological generalization: outside the right edge, monosyllables run into trouble.

(19) a. *Right Edge* b. *Separation* c. *Expansion* d. *Escape*



The task:

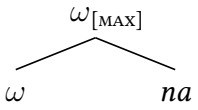
1. Understand this effect
2. Integrate it with a theory of the Phonological ECP
3. Bring the results to bear on the wider theories of Lineraization and Exponence

4 The Phonological ECP

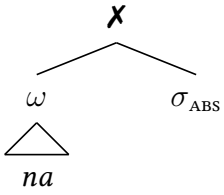
First Ingredient: the future proclitic can't host clitics and can't license vpe alone because it's idiosyncratically unable to form a word. (Inkelas 1989; Kalin & Rolle 2023)

(20) *The First Restriction*

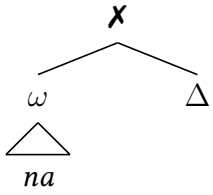
a. *Subcategorization*



b. *Hosting Clitics*



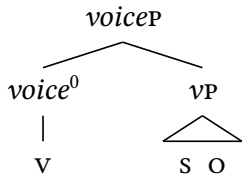
c. *Licensing VPE*



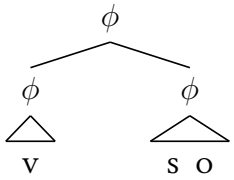
Why this matters: morphosyntactic xps are mapped to phonological phrases. (Nespor & Vogel 1986; Truckenbrodt 1995; Selkirk 2009; Elfner 2012; Kalivoda 2018)

(21) *VP-Level Mapping*

a.

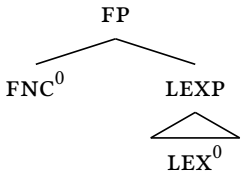


b.

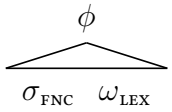


Phonological phrases are always built around the xps projected from lexical heads. (Grimshaw 1991; Selkirk 1995; Truckenbrodt 1995's Lexical Category Condition)

(22) a. *Lexical Projections*



b. *Phonological Phrases*



What this looks like:

(23) a. {ϕ loa masae }H
loa masae
talk long
'A long talk'

b. {ϕ birim bonde }H
birin bonde
edge sand
'Edge of the sand'

c. {ϕ d͡ʒupe tali? }H
d͡ʒupe tali?
NAME NAME
'Jupri Talib'

When functional heads are stranded by movement or ellipsis, they host these tones alone.

(24) *Stranded Heads*

a. {$_{\phi}$ tama ri wojaŋ }^{H}
tama di bod͡ʒaŋ
into P house

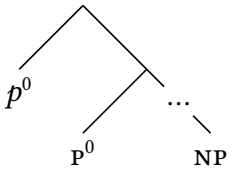
'Into the house'

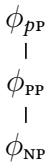
b. {$_{\phi}$ tasmu }^{H} {$_{\phi}$ nawemme }^{H} {$_{\phi}$ tama }^{H}.
tas-mu na-bemmei tama
bag-2GEN 3ERG-fall into ___

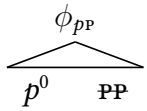
'It fell into YOUR BAG earlier.'

This pattern suggests that phonological phrases are built around functional projections:

(25) *Phrase-Level Mapping*

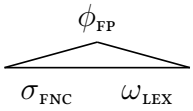
a. 

b. 

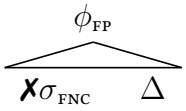
c. 

From this position, we can derive the phonological ECP from the pressure for Headedness: every phonological phrase must eventually dominate a word (Nespor & Vogel 1986).

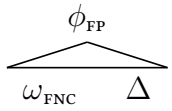
(26) a. *Regular Parse*



b. *Headedness*

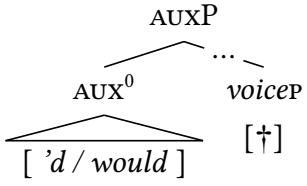


c. *Repair*

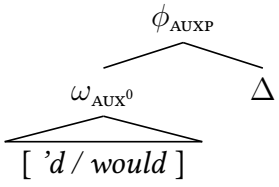


Anderson 2008; Itô & Mester 2019: this constraint drives suppletion.

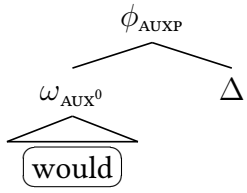
(27) a. *Morphology*



b. *Phonology*



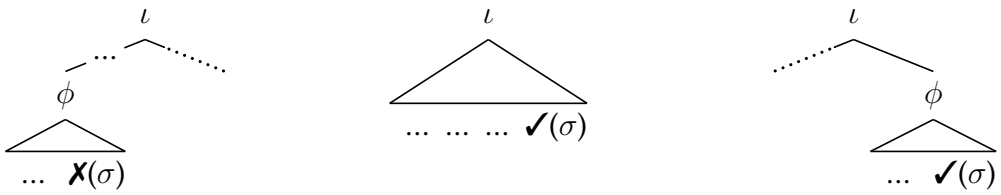
c. *Exponence*



5 Positional Minimality

THE NEXT INGREDIENT: a pair of top-down restrictions on the structure of METRICAL FEET. (Selkirk 1995; Booij 1998; Prieto 2005; Elordieta 2006; McCarthy 2011; Goerwitz 1993)

(28) a. *The Phrase* b. *The Utterance* c. *Licensing*



MANDAR STRESS: disyllabic trochees are built iteratively from the right edge of the word. The language will not parse two heavy syllables into a single foot, and so:

(29) *Final Degenerate Feet*

a. ω — (*sóʔ*) — soup

b. ω — (*sàn*)(*náŋ*) — happy

c. ω — (*kùʔ*)(*míl*) — jackfruit

d. ω — (*tàm*)(*bús*) — set

Degenerate feet are banned at the right edge of the phonological phrase, but they're preferred at the right edge of the utterance:

(30) *Positional Minimality*

a. {$_\phi$ **sóʔoʔ** }^{H} i {$_\phi$ déʔ }^{H}
soʔ i de
soup 3ABS PRT
'It's soup, I guess'

b. {$_\phi$ **táwus** }^{H} i {$_\phi$ déʔ }^{H}
tambus i de
set 3ABS PRT
'It set, I guess'

(31) *Positional Licensing*

a. {$_\phi$ tanje }^{H} {$_\phi$ **sóʔ** }^{H}
tania i soʔ
not be 3ABS soup
'It's not soup'

b. {$_\phi$ pure }^{H} {$_\phi$ **tàmbús** }^{H}
pura i tambus
PAST 3ABS set
'It set'

c. {$_\phi$ pure }^{H} {$_\phi$ (póle) }^{H}
pura i pole
PAST 3ABS come
'They already came'

d. {$_\phi$ pure }^{H} {$_\phi$ (làm)(báʔ) }^{H}
pura i lamba
PAST 3ABS go
'They already went'

6 Back to the Future

Functional heads alternate in ways that trace these constraints:
The negator surfaces as *ndang* in the positions that license phrase-final degenerate feet and expands to *andiang* in the positions that do not (and also: *daʔ*∼*daʔa*; *suŋ*∼*suʔuŋ*...)

(32) a.

wai	uɪundu**ʔ**,	{$_\phi$	tapi	wállo	}^{H}	{$_\phi$	**ndáŋ**	}^{H}.
uai	u-dundu		tapi	ballo**ʔ**			ndaŋ	
water	1ERG-drink		but	palm wine			not	Δ

'The water, I drank, but the palm wine, I didn't.'

b.

di**ʔ**o	uɪuɪu	o,	{$_\phi$	tapi	ɪí**ʔ**e	}^{H}	{$_\phi$	**andíaŋ**	}^{H}	{$_\phi$	é	}^{H}.
do	u-dundu	o		tapi	de			ndaŋ			e	
that	1ERG-drink	PRT		but	this	Δ		not	Δ		PRT	

'That, I drank, but this, I didn't.'

When VPE occurs beneath the negator and the future proclitic,
The positional licensing constraint allows *na* to survive at the right edge of the utterance.
In this context: it retains its position, shows ʔ-epenthesis, and forms a degenerate foot.

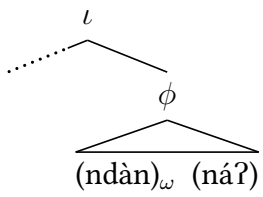
(33) *Positional Licensing*

a.

{$_\phi$	tapi jáu	}^{H}	{$_\phi$	ndàn ná**ʔ**	}^{H}
	tapi YAU			ndaŋ **na**	
	but 1SG			not FUT	

'...but I won't.'

b.

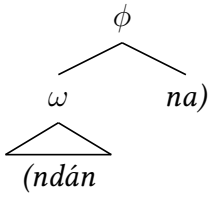


When *na* should fall in positions that impose the Positional Minimality Constraint:

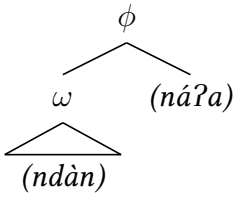
1. It's never parsed into a foot with *ndang*, since they're separated by the edge of a ω.
2. It never undergoes the regular repair of ʔv-epenthesis: it wants to be monosyllabic.
3. So—it shifts left and forces the negator to deal with Positional Minimality instead.

(34) *Positional Minimality*

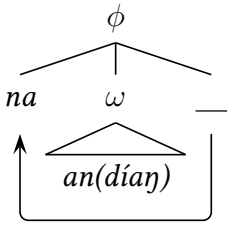
a. ✗*Refooting*



b. ✗*Epenthesis*



c. *Time Travel*



7 The Structure of Linearization

Preliminary hypothesis: linear order is absent from the narrow syntax (Chomsky 1995): it is not seen, referenced, or established by the operations and constraints of that module.

Along the pf branch:

1. Linear order is established between x^0s & complements on the basis of c-command by ranked and violable versions of the lca (Kayne 1994; López 2009; Kusmer 2020)
2. Adjuncts & specifiers are generally linearized to the left; head-specific requirements can force linearization to the right (Hunter & Frank 2014; Kusmer 2020)

Linearization in the Morphology:

3. Concatenation must occur before vi: allomorph selection is sensitive to adjacency.
4. Linear order must be present as well, since morphological operations can refer to individual edges of m-domains (for instance: word-internal second-position effects)
5. Further morphological operations must follow the initial round of linearization: node-insertion; generalized reduplication; local dislocation…

(Adger 2006; Merchant & Pavlou 2017; Kramer 2010; Arregi & Nevins 2012; Myler 2013)

Transfer to the Phonology:

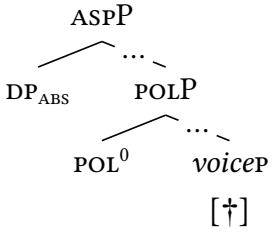
6. The complete output of the morphological module is sent to the phonology at once. Morphosyntactic constituents are translated into phonological domains in a global and parallel calculus that is driven by ranked and violable constraints.
7. There is no cycle in the phrasal phonology.

(Kiparsky 1985; Nespor & Vogel 1986; Selkirk 1995; Elfner 2012; Cheng & Downing 2016)

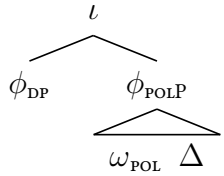
Prosodic Structure-Building:

8. max constraints: "every xp in the input corresponds to a ϕ in the output."
9. ident constraints: "output ϕs are aligned with their corresponding input xps."
10. output constraints: "output ϕs have to meet purely phonological requirements."

(35) a.



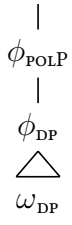
b.



c. ✗ι



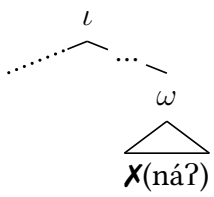
d. ✗ι

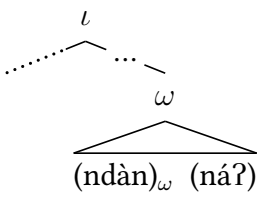


Preparing for Travel:

11. Positional Licensing: "the ι must be right-aligned with a degenerate foot."
12. Subcat one: "the exponent of $\sqrt{\text{FUT}}$ cannot form an independent ω."
13. NoShift: "the order that holds at the end of the morphology between terminal nodes must be reinstantiated over their output correspondents in the phonology."

(36) *Preservation of Order*

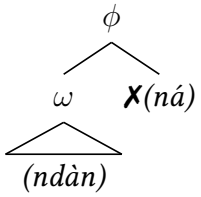
a. 

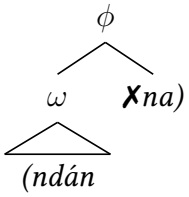
b. 

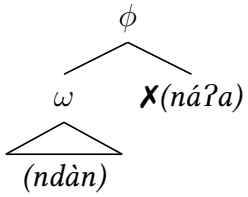
Time Travel:

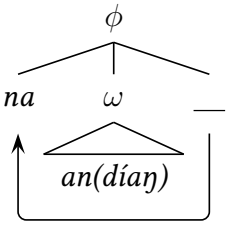
14. Positional Minimality: "the ϕ must be right-aligned with a disyllabic trochee."
15. Proper Bracketing: "metrical feet must be exhaustively contained in ωs."
16. Subcat two: "the exponent of $\sqrt{\text{FUT}}$ must be exactly one syllable."

(37) *Phonological Relinearization*

a. 

b. 

c. 

d. 

Narrow Results:

1. The phonology can reposition prosodic constituents across prosodic structures.
2. Phonological relinearization can be directly forced by output constraints.
3. Phonological relinearization can follow the logic of push movement.

The Bigger Picture:

4. Surface order $\approx$ surface constituent structure: established within a gradual process of translation, where it's reworked by the operations + constraints of each module.
5. Relinearization can be deployed in multi-part repairs to top-down constraints, so it must occur in a phonological calculus that's global + parallel (Adler & Zymet 2021).

(Noyer 1994; Halpern 1995; Bennett *et al.* 2016; Aissen 2017; Kusmer 2019; Ionova 2019)

8 Concluding Question: What about Exponence?

The pressures in this system force a range of alternations.
One analysis: item-specific phonology (Pater 2000; Gouskova 2012)

(38) *Suppletive Monosyllables*

English		Mandar		
sh', c'	*should, could*	*ndang*	*andiang*	NOT
'd, 'll, 've	*would, will, have*	*de, do*	*di'e, di'o*	THIS/THAT
's, 're, 'm	*is/has, are, am*	*na, nai*	*inna, innai*	WHICH/WHO
t', fr, w, ə	*to, for, with, of*	*a*	*apa*	WHAT

The more ambitious alternative:

1. Vocabulary insertion proceeds in two parts: MATCH & INSERT
2. MATCH is what happens at the end of the morphological module:
   terminal nodes are lined up with exponents that match them best in the vocabulary.
3. INSERT is a phonological operation that applies in an optimizing calculus,
   inserting exponents in a system that has access to global phonological context,
   output constraints, and the item-specific requirements of individual exponents.
4. Phonologically optimizing patterns of allomorph selection
   emerge when MATCH selects multiple exponents and leaves the choice to INSERT.

(Mester, 1994; Drachman *et al.*, 1995; Kager, 1996; Tranel, 1996; Mascaró, 1996, 2007; Dolbey, 1997; Perlmutter, 1998; Booij, 1998; Rubach & Booij, 2001; Lapointe, 1999; Klein, 2003; González, 2005; Wolf, 2007, 2008; Bennett, 2017; Raffelsiefen, 1996, 1999; Henderson, 2012)

NECESSARY INGREDIENTS:

5. The morphology is responsible for most allomorph selection (like linearization)
6. Phonological allomorph selection can be forced by SUBCAT (like relinearization)
7. Phonological allomorph selection can be driven by Elsewhere Conditions of its own
   (the lexicon can state which exponents are unmarked; it's not all output constraints).

CHALLENGES:

8. OPACITY
9. INWARD-SENSITIVITY

CONNECTIONS:

10. Ellipsis
11. Chain Reduction

(Franks 1999; Bošković 2001; Bošković & Nunes 2007; Weir 2014; Bennett *et al.* 2019)

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